Vidya Market Validation Report

Research date: 17 October 2026. Companion to Vidya PRD v0.2. Evidence labels: Verified (vendor-stated) = on the vendor's own page, not independently tested; Corroborated = several independent sources; Reported = one credible secondary source; Unverified; Conflicting.

1. Bottom line

The evidence does not yet justify committing to an MVP beyond de-risking work. There have been no customer interviews, no independent complaint data was found, and almost every price and problem claim comes from a vendor selling something.

What is solid:

- **Feature parity is not a reason to switch.** Entab, Fedena and Teachmint each state that they cover attendance, fees, timetable and a parent app. Building those well makes Vidya viable, not chosen.
- **The price floor is near zero for basics.** Teachmint reportedly has a free plan since 1 April 2025 (Reported, one source), and listed prices run from Rs 0 to Rs 1,500 per student per year depending on the vendor. Vidya cannot win small schools on price.
- **One external deadline is verified.** The DPDP Rules published in the Gazette on 13 November 2025 make most duties, including children's-data rules, effective about 13 May 2027 (Section 8).

What this means: Phase 0 should test one claim, that schools will pay for **trustworthy records, assisted migration and compliance-ready data handling** over a free or cheap tool. Kill criteria are in Section 9.

2. What was and was not researched

Area	Done	Not found or not done
Entab, Fedena, Teachmint	Official pages and listings read via search results	No hands-on trial; official pricing pages not opened directly

Area	Done	Not found or not done
VidyalayaERP	Gartner Peer Insights listing (vendor-supplied, updated 18 May 2026)	Official site and documentation
MyClassboard, MyClassCampus, Edunext, Schoollog	Only aggregator mentions	**Unverified**: no official source checked
Customer problems	Reviews and buyer-guide pages	**No Reddit or administrator-community evidence found** in two searches; no interviews
DPDP Rules	Gazette text of G.S.R. 846(E) read in full (third-party mirror)	meity.gov.in copy could not be opened; the Act's own sections 8 and 9 not read
Spring Boot	Official 4.1 system-requirements page	Third-party library compatibility; the exact 4.1.1 patch notes

3. Competitor matrix

Product	Positioning	Stated coverage	Pricing evidence	Customers	Label
Entab CampusCare	K-12 schools, premium and CBSE focus per third-party lists	11 core and 21+ modules stated: student info, fees, exams and report cards, staff, accounting, inventory, library, parent portal, lesson planning. **Timetable substitution, SMS, WhatsApp, email, hostel, health, alumni and API integration are listed as separate add-on modules**	Not published. Estimates conflict (Section 4)	Own pages say 2,000+ to 2,300+; third-party pages say 1,200, 1,500+ and 3,000	Verified (vendor-stated) for modules; **Conflicting** for price and customer count
Entab fee module	Fees	Class, category and term structures, instalments, concessions, late fees, security-deposit refunds, parent portal and app; multi-branch fee centralisation stated; GST and PFMS compliance claimed	Not published	n/a	Verified (vendor-stated); compliance claims unverified

Product	Positioning	Stated coverage	Pricing evidence	Customers	Label
Fedena	Small-to-mid institutions, K-12 and higher ed	Admissions, records, attendance, exams, certificates, fees, HR, transport, hostel, timetable; mobile app; multi-school dashboard	Pro Plus $1,299/yr on several listings; Enterprise custom and includes source code; another listing shows from $999	n/a; a 12–15% India share claim from a vendor blog is **Unverified**	Corroborated (listings may share vendor data) for price; Reported for limitations
Teachmint	Integrated school platform plus classroom hardware; LMS roots	Attendance, fees, timetable, parent portal, notifications, online classes, analytics	No public school price; free plan post 1 Apr 2025 and per-classroom licence of INR 12,711 from year 2 on some hardware bundles, both Reported	n/a	Reported
VidyalayaERP	Indian schools of all sizes	Admissions, attendance, fees, exams, payroll, parent communication; 15-day trial; 'transparent pricing' claimed	Custom per Gartner	n/a	Reported (vendor-supplied)
MyClassboard, MyClassCampus, Edunext, Schoollog	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	**Unverified**

Observations that matter for Vidya:

- Entab sells timetable substitution as an add-on, while Vidya already has it. That is a possible bundling advantage, not yet a validated need.

- Reviewers of Teachmint on G2 and Capterra praise attendance, fees and parent communication, and ask for expense management and deeper reporting. Basics appear adequate for at least some schools, so attendance and fee features alone are not an opening.
- Fedena is described by one aggregator as needing multi-module configuration and data cleanup before use (Reported).
- An aggregator summary lists Edunext issues (slow implementation, app and server problems, transport and exam limits), but that page is over three years old per search metadata.

4. Price evidence: figures conflict and are mostly vendor-written

Figure	Source and type	Why it may differ
Entab Rs 1.5–8 lakh/yr; Rs 3–10 lakh year one for 1,000 students	Fuzen comparison, competitor vendor, 2026	Quote-based, per module, implementation fees
Entab Rs 25,000–80,000/yr	Codingclave, software vendor, 2026	Different school sizes and scope
Fedena $1,299/yr and $999	Software Advice via GetApp; Fitgap	Per feature versus per plan; listing dates
Teachmint Rs 100–300 per student per year	Fuzen, citing community discussions	Estimate by a competitor; free plan reported
Rs 150–600 per student per year core; Rs 600–1,500 with exams, transport, apps	Opta Tech, custom-build agency	Agency sells custom builds
Rs 0–7.81 per student per month	AI EDU, vendor	Vendor marketing

Resolved value: none. Illustration only: at Rs 150–600 per student per year, an 800-student school would pay Rs 1.2–4.8 lakh a year. Vidya's real floor depends on per-tenant database cost, which has not been modeled.

5. Customer problems: hypotheses and their evidence

Problem	Evidence found	Independent?	Status
Fee follow-up consumes office hours; ERPs are passive ledgers with no recovery workflow (promise-to-pay, call logs)	Vedaloop, FastFee; both sell competing products	No	Hypothesis; **possible gap, since no competitor page checked mentions recovery workflows**, which is absence of evidence only
Per-module price creep	Vedaloop advice; Entab's own add-on module list shows how modules are split	Partly	Structure verified; complaints unverified
Migration and setup effort	Fitgap Fedena summary	Aggregator	Reported
Slow implementation, app problems	SoftwareSuggest on Edunext, dated	Aggregator	Reported, stale
Support in regional languages	Vedaloop (Telugu)	No	Unverified
Software slows as student numbers grow	Generic claim on SoftwareSuggest	No data	Unverified
Low adoption: daily use is mainly attendance, marks, report cards, fee reminders	Opta Tech advice	No	Opinion; useful as a pilot test, not as evidence

Customer validation remains incomplete. A competitor feature gap is not a customer problem until a school describes the pain unprompted.

6. Segment comparison (author judgment, not evidence)

Segment	Pain	Willing to pay	Access to buyer	Competition	Onboarding effort	Sales cycle	Support burden	Retention	Fit with Vidya today
Small (under 300)	Medium	Low (free plans)	High	High	Low	Short	High per rupee	Medium	Medium; per-tenant database cost is a risk
Medium single campus (300–1,500)	Medium-high	Medium	High	High	Medium	Medium	Medium	High once fees run on it	**High**
Large single campus (1,500+)	High	High	Medium	High (Entab)	High	Long	High	High	Low-medium: needs fees, exams, transport, integrations
Multi-branch group (2–10)	High (consolidated view; unverified)	Medium-high	Medium	Medium (claims exist, depth unverified)	High	Long	Medium	High	Medium: community networks exist, branch analytics do not
Low-IT schools	Medium	Low-medium	High	High	High	Medium	High	Medium	Needs assisted onboarding

Recommendation: keep the medium single-campus school as the working beachhead because of fit and a shorter cycle, but interview multi-branch groups in Phase 0 and choose after the interviews. Evidence still needed: willingness to pay above the free-plan alternative, who signs, and when schools switch vendors (academic-year timing is assumed, not verified).

7. Differentiation candidates, ranked by evidence

Candidate	Evidence	Easily copied?	Verdict
DPDP-ready data handling: per-tenant database isolation, access logs, breach support, parent-consent flows	**Legal deadlines verified**; demand and willingness to pay unproven	Claims are easy; per-tenant physical isolation is hard to retrofit, but competitors' architectures are unverified	**Strongest evidence-backed opening, still unvalidated**
Assisted migration and fast setup	Reported pain (Fedena)	Service is copyable; tooling and know-how are durable	Test first
Fee recovery workflow	Vendor-claimed only	Copyable	Test with accountants
Transparent all-inclusive pricing	Vendor-claimed; add-on structure verified at Entab	Easily copied	Weak alone
Feature breadth	None	n/a	Do not pursue

8. Verified legal and technical baseline

DPDP Rules 2025 (Gazette G.S.R. 846(E), 13 Nov 2025, read via mirror). Secondary sources say 14 November 2025 for publication; the Gazette text is dated 13 November. Confirm against meity.gov.in.

- **Commencement (Rule 1):** Rules 1, 2 and 17–21 on publication; Rule 4 (consent managers) after one year, about 13 Nov 2026; Rules 3, 5–16, 22, 23 after eighteen months, about **13 May 2027**.
- **Security (Rule 6):** encryption, masking or tokens; access control; logs and monitoring; backups for continuity; logs and personal data kept one year for investigation; processor contracts with safeguards.
- **Breach (Rule 7):** notify affected people without delay; notify the Board without delay and give detailed information within 72 hours.

- **Retention (Rule 8(3)):** personal data, traffic data and logs kept at least one year for specified purposes.
- **Children (Rule 10):** verifiable parental consent before processing a child's data, with a check that the parent is an identifiable adult.
- **Exemption (Rule 12, Fourth Schedule item 3):** section 9(1) and (3) do not apply to educational institutions, but only where processing is restricted to tracking and behavioural monitoring for the institution's educational activities or children's safety.
- **Grievances (Rule 14(3)):** response period not exceeding 90 days.

For legal review: the school is likely the fiduciary and Vidya a processor, but this is not confirmed; whether fee, parent-portal and notification processing falls inside the exemption is unclear; consent design for parents.

Spring Boot: the official 4.1 system-requirements page says it needs Java 17 or later, is compatible up to and including Java 25, requires Spring Framework 7.x, and supports Tomcat 11 (Servlet 6.1) with Gradle 8.14+ or 9 or Maven 3.6.3+. Compatibility of Spring Session, Lettuce, Hibernate, Flyway and Testcontainers versions with your exact build is unchecked. One secondary source says Spring Boot has no LTS line and about 12 months of free support per minor, so plan regular upgrades.

9. Validation plan

Interviews (8–12): 3 owners or trustees, 3 principals or administrators, 2 accountants or fee clerks, 2 teachers. Cover at least two states, CBSE and a state board, single-campus and 2–5-branch schools, and users of Entab, Fedena, Teachmint or spreadsheets. Do not pitch features.

Non-leading questions:

1. Walk me through the last time a parent paid fees, from the first reminder to the receipt.
2. Tell me about the last time attendance or a timetable went wrong. What happened next?
3. What tool do you use for this today, and who chose it?
4. What do you pay in total each year, including SMS, add-ons and support?
5. What did you try before the current tool, and why did you stop?
6. When did you last consider changing, and what stopped you?
7. Who must agree before you buy anything, and what is the process?

8. When in the year can you change systems?
9. How was your data moved into the current system, and who did the work?
10. How do parents hear from the school today, and what do they complain about?
11. What does your accountant do with fee data afterwards?
12. What do you do about student data privacy and consent today?
13. Which tasks do teachers skip or do twice?
14. If this stopped working tomorrow, what would break first?

Proposed go/no-go thresholds (to be agreed before interviewing):

- Proceed if at least 6 of 10 describe an unprompted, costly problem in the same workflow within the last 3 months, and at least 3 will commit to a paid pilot or written intent with a start date.
- Re-think the segment or product if most schools are content with a free or cheap tool, or none will give pilot time.

Pricing experiment: ask each buyer for their current total spend and budget before showing any price; then show a flat per-school plan and a per-student plan with a minimum; finish with a small paid pilot. The cost floor needs a per-tenant infrastructure model first.

10. Open questions that block the MVP

- Which workflow do schools pain over enough to switch: fees, attendance, migration, or compliance?
- What is the per-tenant monthly infrastructure cost, and therefore the minimum price?
- Who is the fiduciary, and which processing needs parental consent?
- Do multi-branch groups have a deeper unmet need than single schools?

11. Sources (opened or surfaced 17 October 2026)

- Entab: management page, fee module, mobile app page, SoftwareONE listing
- Fedena: GetApp, Fitgap, Software Advice
- Teachmint: Fitgap summary, Techjockey Teachmint X, G2 reviews
- Other: Gartner VidyalayaERP, SoftwareSuggest
- Vendor and agency pages (low weight): Fuzen, Codingclave, Opta Tech, Vedaloop, FastFee, AI EDU

- Law: Gazette text G.S.R. 846(E), PwC note, Mondaq/Sagus
- Technology: Spring Boot 4.1 system requirements, Spring Boot 3.5 requirements page
- Market: UDISE+ 2024-25 analysis